Budget Template · Expert version

A budget template lets you plan spending by category and month, record actuals and see variances immediately, whether you are budgeting for a project, a team or your household.

How to use this template

1. List income and cost categories that matter to you.
2. Enter planned amounts for the month (and the year on the second tab).
3. Record actual figures as they come in.
4. Check variances: totals and percentages calculate automatically.
5. Adjust next month's plan based on what you learn.

Tips

- Update actuals weekly so surprises are small.
- Keep a contingency line.
- Use Google Sheets to share the budget with your team.
- For projects, track cost variance and EVM.

Dashboard (sample data)

Field	Value	Count
Category	Income	1
Category	Marketing	1
Category	Net (income − costs)	1
Category	Other	1
Category	Salaries / labour	1
Category	Software and tools	1
Category	Total costs	1
Category	Travel	1

Monthly budget · Positive variance = under budget for costs, above plan for income

Category	Planned ($)	Actual ($)	Variance ($)	Variance (%)	Notes
Income	6,000	6,200	200	3%	
Salaries / labour	3,000	3,100	-100	-3%	
Software and tools	400	380	20	5%	
Marketing	600	720	-120	-20%	Extra ad spend
Travel	300	150	150	50%	
Other	200	210	-10	-5%	
Total costs	4,500	4,560	-60	-1%	
Net (income − costs)	1,500	1,640	140		

Annual by month · Twelve-month view

Category	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Total
Income	6,000	6,000	6,200	6,200	6,400	6,400	6,400	6,400	6,600	6,600	6,800	6,800	76,800
Costs	4,500	4,500	4,600	4,600	4,700	4,700	4,700	4,800	4,800	4,900	4,900	5,000	56,700
Net	1,500	1,500	1,600	1,600	1,700	1,700	1,700	1,600	1,800	1,700	1,900	1,800	20,100